

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12409833
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 09, 2025
Inventor(s)	Sawada; Fukuei

Clutch device and collision mitigation mechanism

Abstract

When a collision occurs, a driving force of a drive shaft is transmitted to a reversing high-load multiple disk clutch via an inertia absorbing gear mechanism. Then, the driving force is transmitted to a gear via a gear, and inertia is absorbed and the driving force acts to rotate an output shaft at a low speed. On the other hand, when the gear rotates, a regenerative/backing up motor also rotates, and so-called regenerative driving is also performed. Due to these operations, the output shaft rapidly decreases in rotation speed, and goes into a rotation stopping state from a forward rotating state. Then, when a vehicle speed sensor detects that the vehicle speed has reached “0,” the regenerative/backing up motor is driven, the output shaft is driven to rotate reversely for several seconds, and thereafter, driving of the regenerative/backing up motor is stopped.

Inventors:	Sawada; Fukuei (Tokorozawa, JP)
Applicant:	Sawada; Fukuei (Tokorozawa, JP)
Family ID:	77269512
Appl. No.:	17/463884
Filed:	September 01, 2021

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20220073061 A1	Mar. 10, 2022

Foreign Application Priority Data

JP	2020-149490	Sep. 04, 2020
----	-------------	---------------

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **B60W30/09** (20120101); **B60K6/38** (20071001); **B60L7/10** (20060101); **B60W10/02** (20060101); **B60W10/08** (20060101); **B60W30/18** (20120101); B60K6/26 (20071001); B60W20/00 (20160101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **B60W30/09** (20130101); **B60L7/10** (20130101); **B60W10/02** (20130101); **B60W10/08** (20130101); **B60W30/18054** (20130101); B60K6/26 (20130101); B60K6/38 (20130101); B60W20/00 (20130101); B60W2520/10 (20130101); B60W2520/12 (20130101); B60W2540/10 (20130101); B60W2540/12 (20130101); B60W2540/16 (20130101); B60W2540/18 (20130101); B60W2552/15 (20200201); B60W2710/022 (20130101); B60W2710/083 (20130101); B60W2720/10 (20130101); B60W2720/24 (20130101); B60Y2200/92 (20130101); B60Y2300/09 (20130101); B60Y2300/42 (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: B60W (10/02); B60W (10/08); B60W (20/00); B60W (2030/082); B60W (2520/10); B60W (2520/12); B60W (2540/10); B60W (2540/12); B60W (2540/16); B60W (2540/18); B60W (2552/15); B60W (2554/00); B60W (2554/802); B60W (2710/022); B60W (2710/083); B60W (2720/10); B60W (2720/24); B60W (30/08); B60W (30/09); B60W (30/18036); B60W (30/18054); B60W (50/12); B60K (2006/541); B60K (6/26); B60K (6/38); B60K (6/387); B60L (15/2009); B60L (15/2054); B60L (2240/507); B60L (3/0007); B60L (7/10); B60Y (2200/92); B60Y (2300/09); B60Y (2300/42); B60Y (2302/05); F16D (2023/126); F16D (2023/0643); F16D (2023/065); H02K (49/102); Y02T (10/64); Y02T (10/72)

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
5013949	12/1990	Mabe, Jr.	310/83	H02K 49/102
5456345	12/1994	Bissett	192/70.252	F16D 13/757
6005317	12/1998	Lamb	N/A	N/A
2002/0132670	12/2001	Killen	464/29	H02K 49/046
2013/0054103	12/2012	Herink	701/65	B60T 7/22
2016/0036311	12/2015	Lee	N/A	N/A
2016/0272187	12/2015	Yukawa	N/A	B60K 6/26
2019/0032731	12/2018	Eo	N/A	F16D 23/02
2019/0039597	12/2018	Hawley	N/A	B60W 30/18127

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
2001-82507	12/2000	JP	N/A
2005163936	12/2004	JP	N/A
2005-264982	12/2004	JP	N/A
2007-85477	12/2006	JP	N/A
2012-145143	12/2011	JP	N/A

2014-109375	12/2013	JP	N/A
2016-118238	12/2015	JP	N/A
2017-128167	12/2016	JP	N/A
WO-2008085931	12/2007	WO	H02K 49/102

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Japan Patent Office, “Office Action for Japanese Patent Application No. 2020-149490,” Dec. 21, 2020. cited by applicant

Extended European Search Report for European Application No. 24190836.7 dated Oct. 31, 2024; 8 pp. cited by applicant

Primary Examiner: Chad; Aniss

Assistant Examiner: Huynh; Christine Nguyen

Attorney, Agent or Firm: HAUPTMAN HAM, LLP

Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present invention relates to a clutch device and a collision mitigation mechanism for a vehicle such as an automobile.

BACKGROUND ART

(2) In a conventional automobile, a driving force of an engine is transmitted from the engine to a transmission via a mechanical or electrical clutch and a torque converter. For example, Patent Document 1 listed below discloses an electromagnetic clutch configured to be more compact than a conventional clutch by reducing a magnetic resistance in a magnetic path by filling a magnetic fluid between a field core and a drive pulley.

CITATION LIST

Patent Document

(3) [Patent Document 1] Japanese Published Unexamined Patent Application No. 2014-109375

SUMMARY OF INVENTION

Technical Problem

(4) Nowadays, there is strong demand for improvement in fuel efficiency and environmental measures, and hybrid type and electric-motor driven automobiles are being researched and developed. However, a hybrid type uses both of a gasoline engine and an electric motor, so that its structure and control are extremely complicated. On the other hand, in an electric-motor driven automobile, there is a need for further research into power storage capacity and charging method of batteries, and there are challenges involving the building up of charging facilities.

(5) On the other hand, accidents caused by mistakes in stepping on an accelerator pedal instead of a brake pedal have increased. Of course, it would be best to prevent such accidents, but as a next best solution, mitigation of damage from such an accident when an accident occurs is advantageous.

(6) The present invention has been made in view of these considerations, and an object thereof is to realize effective use of energy, an improvement in fuel efficiency, and reduction in environmental load. Another object is to mitigate damage from a collision.

Solution to Problem

(7) The present invention provides a collision mitigation mechanism which mitigates damage from a vehicle collision, including a collision detection means that detects a collision of a vehicle, a

clutch means that blocks transmission of a driving force of a drive source when a collision is detected by the collision detection means, a deceleration and stop means that rapidly decelerates and stops the vehicle, a backing up means that backs up and stops the vehicle after the vehicle is stopped by the deceleration and stop means, and a collision mitigation control means that, when a collision is detected by the collision detection means, rapidly decelerates and stops the vehicle by the deceleration and stop means, and after the vehicle stops, backs up and stops the vehicle by the backing up means.

(8) Another aspect of the present invention provides a clutch device that is used as the clutch means of the collision mitigation mechanism, and includes an idle running mechanism that turns ON and OFF transmission of power of an input side to an output side, and an idle running control device that controls the turning ON/OFF, wherein the idle running mechanism includes an input-side rotor and an output-side rotor including pluralities of magnets aligned so as to have alternate polarities, and a sliding means that transmits rotation of the input-side rotor to the output-side rotor by a magnetic force generated between the magnets of the input-side rotor and the magnets of the output-side rotor when the idle running mechanism is ON, and slides at least one of the rotors so that no magnetic force is generated between the magnets of the input-side rotor and the magnets of the output-side rotor when the idle running mechanism is OFF, and the idle running control device includes a sensor means that detects a running state of the vehicle and road conditions, and an idle running control means that determines whether safe idle running is possible based on detection results by the sensor means, and outputs a corresponding idle running control signal to the sliding means. The aforementioned and other objects, features, and advantages of the present invention will become clear from the following detailed description and accompanying drawings.

Effect of Invention

(9) According to the present invention, when a collision is detected, a rapid deceleration of a vehicle is performed, and after the vehicle stops, the vehicle is backed up and stopped, so that further expansion of the collision accident is reduced, and damage is mitigated. In addition, by the idle running mechanism, a state where safe idle running is possible is detected by the idle running control device and idle running is performed, so that while the configuration is simple, effective use of energy can be realized, and an improvement in fuel efficiency and reduction in environmental load can be realized.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

- (1) FIGS. 1(A) and 1(B) are diagrams illustrating a configuration of an idle running mechanism of Example 1 of the present invention.
- (2) FIGS. 2(A) and 2(B) are views of the Example 1 from the arrow F2 direction.
- (3) FIGS. 3(A), 3(B) and 3(C) are diagrams illustrating dispositions of the idle running mechanism of the Example 1 in automobiles.
- (4) FIG. 4 is a diagram illustrating a control device of an example of the present invention.
- (5) FIG. 5 is a flowchart illustrating an operation of an idle running control program of the Example 1.
- (6) FIGS. 6(A) and 6(B) are diagrams illustrating a running example of an automobile and an example of operation of the idle running mechanism.
- (7) FIGS. 7(A), 7(B) and 7(C) are views illustrating configurations of an idle running mechanism and an impact reducing mechanism of Example 2 of the present invention.
- (8) FIG. 8 is a view of the impact reducing mechanism of the Example 2 as viewed from the arrow F8 direction.
- (9) FIG. 9 is a flowchart illustrating an operation of the impact reducing program of the Example 2.

(10) FIG. **10** is a diagram illustrating a collision mitigation mechanism of Example 3 of the present invention.

(11) FIG. **11(A)** is a diagram illustrating a control device of the Example 3, and FIG. **11(B)** is a flowchart illustrating operation of the control device.

(12) FIG. **12** is a view illustrating a state at the time of deceleration/regeneration in the Example 3.

(13) FIG. **13** is a view illustrating a state at the time of backing up in the Example 3.

(14) FIG. **14** is a diagram illustrating a running operation example in the Example 3.

(15) FIG. **15** is a view illustrating a state at the time of low speed/low-speed rotation in Example 4 of the present invention.

(16) FIG. **16** is a view illustrating a state at the time of medium speed/medium-speed rotation in the Example 4.

(17) FIG. **17** is a view illustrating a state at the time of high-speed rotation in the Example 4.

(18) FIG. **18** is a view illustrating a state at the time of inertia/regeneration in the Example 4.

(19) FIG. **19** is a view illustrating a state at the time of reversing/backing up in the Example 4.

(20) FIG. **20** is a diagram illustrating the entirety of an operation example of the Example 4.

DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENT

(21) Hereinafter, an embodiment for carrying out the present invention will be described in detail based on examples.

Example 1

(22) FIGS. **1(A)** and **1(B)** illustrate an idle running mechanism of a clutch device according to the present example, and FIG. **1(A)** illustrates an “ON” state where a driving force is transmitted from an input shaft to an output shaft, and FIG. **1(B)** illustrates an “OFF” state where a driving force is not transmitted from the input shaft to the output shaft. FIGS. **2(A)** and **2(B)** illustrates a state of a major portion viewed from an axial direction. In these drawings, the idle running mechanism **100** has a configuration in which a plurality of outer rotors **110** and an inner rotor **150** surrounded by the outer rotors are disposed. At an outer circumference of the outer rotor **110**, a large number of magnets **112** are provided adjacent to each other, and at an outer circumference of the inner rotor **150**, a large number of magnets **152** are provided adjacent to each other. Polarities of these magnets **112** and **152** have magnetization (magnetizing) directions set in thickness directions or radial directions, and are magnetized so that their N and S polarities become alternately opposite to each other.

(23) The outer rotors **110** are rotatable around rotary shafts **114**, and these rotary shafts **114** are driven to rotate by a gear mechanism **120**. The gear mechanism **120** consists of a main gear **134** provided on a drive shaft **132** of an engine (or motor) **130**, and a plurality of driven gears **136** that mesh with the main gear, and the plurality of driven gears **136** are provided on the rotary shafts **114** of the outer rotors **110**. That is, when the drive shaft **132** is rotated by the engine **130**, the main gear **134** rotates, and further, the driven gears **136** rotate and the rotary shafts **114** rotate, and accordingly, the outer rotors **110** rotate. On the other hand, the inner rotor **150** is supported rotatably by a driven shaft **154**, and rotation of this driven shaft **154** is transmitted to an axle **204** (refer to FIGS. **3(A)**, **3(B)** and **3(C)**) of the automobile.

(24) A small clearance is formed between the magnets **112** on the outer circumferential surfaces of the outer rotors **110** and the magnets **152** on the outer circumferential surface of the inner rotor **150** so as to avoid a contact between these magnets. The inner rotor **150** is configured to be slidable in the direction of the driven shaft **154** by a sliding mechanism **160**. In the illustrated example, by biasing a lever **162** attached to the driven shaft **154** by a spring **164** at one side and biasing the lever by an idle running control actuator **166** at the other side toward an opposite direction, the outer rotors **110** are slid.

(25) In the state illustrated in FIG. **1(A)**, the lever **162** is pulled by the spring **164**, and magnetic forces of the magnets **112** of the outer rotors **110** and the magnets **152** of the inner rotor **150** influence each other. Therefore, when the outer rotors **110** rotate, due to action of the magnetic

forces of the magnets **112** and **152**, the inner rotor **150** rotates. That is, a driving force of the engine **130** is transmitted from the outer rotors **110** to the inner rotor **150** via the gear mechanism **120**, and the driven shaft **154** rotates. This state is a state where idle running is ON.

(26) On the other hand, in the state illustrated in FIG. **1(B)**, the lever **162** is pulled by the idle running control actuator **166** against the force of the spring **164**, the inner rotor **150** moves to a position slid from the position of the outer rotors **110**, and the magnetic forces of the magnets **112** and **152** do not influence each other. Therefore, even when the outer rotors **110** rotate, magnetic forces of the magnets **112** and **152** do not act, and the inner rotor **150** does not rotate. That is, the driving force of the engine **130** is not transmitted to the inner rotor **150** although it is transmitted to the outer rotors **110** via the gear mechanism **120**, and the driven shaft **154** does not rotate. This state is a state where idle running is OFF.

(27) FIGS. **3(A)**, **3(B)** and **3(C)** illustrate the entirety of a power transmission system including the above-described idle running mechanism **100**. In the example of FIG. **3(A)**, the idle running mechanism **100** is provided between the engine **130** and a clutch mechanism **200**, and a driving force of the clutch mechanism **200** is transmitted to the axle **204** via a transmission mechanism **202**. The idle running mechanism **100** may be provided between the clutch mechanism **200** and the transmission mechanism **202**. In the example of FIG. **3(B)**, a motor **230** is used instead of the engine **130**, and a driving force of the motor is transmitted to the axle **204** via the idle running mechanism **100**.

(28) Next, an idle running control device of the present example will be described with reference to FIGS. **4** and **5**. FIG. **4** illustrates a configuration of an idle running control device **300** in which various switches or sensors **302** to **314** are connected to an ECU (engine control unit) **320**. Among these, an accelerator switch **302** is a switch that detects whether an accelerator pedal has been stepped on, and for example, this switch is ON when the accelerator pedal is stepped on, and OFF when the accelerator pedal is not stepped on. The vehicle speed sensor **304** is a sensor that detects a running speed of the automobile. A brake switch **306** is a switch for detecting whether a brake pedal has been stepped on, and for example, it is ON when the brake pedal is stepped on, and is OFF when the brake pedal is not stepped on.

(29) A handle steering angle sensor **308** is a sensor that detects whether a handle (steering wheel) has been turned as in the case of traveling on a curve, etc. A shift position switch **310** is a switch that detects a position of a shift lever, and is ON when the shift lever is at a top gear position, and is OFF when the shift lever is at other positions. A front obstacle detection sensor **312** is a sensor that detects whether an obstacle is present in front of the automobile. A road surface angle sensor **314** is a sensor that detects whether a road surface ahead on the road is a slope. Other sensors, etc., will be described later.

(30) In the ECU **320**, an idle running control program **322** is prepared, and by executing this, according to detection results by the above-described switches or sensors **302** to **314**, an operation control signal is output to the idle running control actuator **166**. FIG. **5** illustrates a flow of this operation. The ECU **320** has a function to control the entire operation of the automobile such as the engine or motor and air conditioning in addition to the above-described operations. An impact reducing program **722** will be described later.

(31) Next, operation of the idle running control program **322** in the idle running control device **300** will be described as follows with reference to FIG. **5**. a. When the accelerator pedal is stepped on and the accelerator switch **302** is ON (Yes in Step **S10**), it is considered that acceleration or deceleration must be performed by an accelerator pedal operation, so that the driving force needs to be transmitted, and the idle running mechanism **100** is turned ON. That is, a control signal to turn ON the idle running mechanism **100** is output from the ECU **320** to the idle running control actuator **166**, and the idle running mechanism **100** is turned ON (Step **S24**), and as illustrated in FIG. **1(A)**, the driving force is transmitted. b. Even when the vehicle speed sensor **304** detects that the automobile is accelerating (Yes in Step **S12**), the driving force still needs to be transmitted, and

the idle running mechanism **100** is turned ON. c. When the brake pedal is stepped on and the brake switch is ON (Yes in Step **S14**), idle running is considered to be dangerous, so that the idle running mechanism **100** is turned ON. d. When the handle steering angle sensor **308** detects that the handle has been turned to the left or the right (Yes in Step **S16**), the road is curved and idle running in the same manner is considered to be dangerous, so that the idle running mechanism **100** is turned ON. e. When the shift position switch **310** detects that the shift lever is at a position other than the top gear position (No in Step **S18**), the automobile is considered to be accelerating or decelerating, so that the driving force needs to be transmitted, and the idle running mechanism **100** is turned ON. f. When the front obstacle detection sensor **312** detects an obstacle ahead (Yes in Step **S20**), deceleration or handle turning is required, and idle running is considered to be dangerous, so that the idle running mechanism **100** is turned ON. g. When the road surface angle sensor **314** detects that a road surface ahead is upslope or downslope (Yes in Step **S22**), acceleration or engine braking is required, and idle running is considered to be dangerous, so that the idle running mechanism **100** is turned ON.

(32) On the other hand, when the above-described conditions are not satisfied, it is determined that idle running poses no danger, and a control signal to turn OFF the idle running mechanism **100** is output from the ECU **320** to the idle running control actuator **166**, and the idle running mechanism **100** is turned OFF as illustrated in FIG. **1(B)** (Step **S26**). Accordingly, power from the engine **130** is not transmitted, and becomes an idle running state.

(33) Next, the entire operation of the present example will be described with reference to FIGS. **6(A)** and **6(B)** as well. FIG. **6(A)** is a graph illustrating an example of acceleration/deceleration of an automobile, and illustrates speed changes when the automobile accelerates from a time T_a to a time T_b , and is then driven at a constant speed, decelerates from a time T_c to a time T_d , and then accelerates again. FIG. **6(B)** illustrates ON/OFF states of the idle running mechanism **100**.

(34) First, during the acceleration period from the time T_a to the time T_b , the accelerator pedal is stepped on, so that the accelerator switch **302** is turned ON (Yes in Step **S10**). Therefore, in the ECU **320**, a control signal to turn ON the idle running mechanism **100** is output by the idle running control program **322** to the idle running control actuator **166** (refer to FIG. **4**). Accordingly, the idle running control actuator **166** goes into the ON state illustrated in FIG. **1(A)** (Step **S24**), and a driving force of the engine **130** is transmitted from the outer rotors **110** to the inner rotor **150** via the gear mechanism **120**, the driven shaft **154** rotates, and further, via the clutch mechanism **200** and the transmission mechanism **202**, the axle **204** is rotated, and the automobile accelerates. When the automobile is accelerating on a slope, etc., the accelerator pedal may not be stepped on and the accelerator switch **302** may be OFF (No in Step **S10**), however, the vehicle speed sensor **304** detects that the automobile is accelerating (Yes in Step **S12**), so that the idle running mechanism **100** is turned ON as illustrated in FIG. **6(B)** (Step **S24**), and power is transmitted.

(35) Next, during a constant-speed period from the time T_b to the time T_c , the accelerator switch **302** is still ON (No in Step **S10**), so that the idle running mechanism **100** is also kept ON, and power is transmitted.

(36) Next, during the deceleration period from the time T_c to the time T_d , the accelerator pedal is released and the accelerator switch **302** is turned OFF (No in Step **S10**), and the automobile decelerates (No in Step **S12**), so that when the brake pedal is not stepped on (No in Step **S14**), when the handle is not turned (No in Step **S16**), when the shift lever is at the top gear position (Yes in Step **S18**) and no obstacle is present ahead (No in Step **S20**), or when the road surface ahead is not a slope (No in Step **S22**), in the ECU **320**, a control signal to turn OFF the idle running mechanism **100** is output by the idle running control program **322** to the idle running control actuator **166**. Accordingly, the idle running control actuator **166** goes into the OFF state illustrated in FIG. **1(B)** (Step **S26**), and the driving force of the engine **130** is not transmitted to the axle **204** (refer to FIG. **6(B)**). That is, the automobile goes into an idle running state where it runs inertially, and the engine **130** becomes unloaded and idles. Therefore, fuel consumption and an exhaust gas

discharge amount of the engine **130** are reduced, and an improvement in fuel efficiency and reduction in environmental load can be realized. In addition, as illustrated in FIG. 3(B), when the motor **230** is used as a drive source, the motor **230** can be completely stopped, and wasteful energy consumption can be suppressed.

(37) Next, after the time T_d , the automobile is accelerated again, so that the state becomes the same as during the period from the time T_a to the time T_b described above, and the driving force of the engine **130** is transmitted to the axle **204** and the automobile is accelerated.

(38) As described above, according to the present example, the outer rotors **110** and the inner rotor **150** of the idle running mechanism **100** are configured by using permanent magnets, and at the time of deceleration while traveling straight on a flat road, the idle running mechanism **100** is turned OFF and idle running is performed, so that while the configuration is simple, effective use of energy can be realized, and an improvement in fuel efficiency and reduction in environmental load can be realized.

Example 2

(39) Next, Example 2 of the clutch device of the present invention will be described with reference to FIGS. 7(A), 7(B) and 7(C) to **9** as well. FIGS. 7(A), 7(B) and 7(C) illustrate mechanical configurations of the present example, and FIG. 7(A) illustrates an “ON” state where the driving force is transmitted from the input shaft to the output shaft, and FIG. 7(C) illustrates an “OFF” state where the driving force is not transmitted from the input shaft to the output shaft. FIG. **8** is a view from the arrow F8 direction in FIG. 7(C). As illustrated in these drawings, the present Example 2 is an example in which an impact reducing mechanism **500** is provided on an output side of the idle running mechanism **100** described above. The impact reducing mechanism **500** is configured around a rotary disk **510** attached to the driven shaft **154**, and before and after the rotary disk **510**, sliding bodies **520** and **530** that slide along the driven shaft **154** and the output shaft **155** in an axial direction are respectively provided. As illustrated in FIG. 7(B), the driven shaft **154** and the output shaft **155** are engaged with each other via a frictional material **156**, and both of these shafts slide when a certain or more force acts. Accordingly, the operation described later is smoothly performed.

(40) The rotary disk **510** is provided with a rotation control gear **512** using the driven shaft **154** as a rotary shaft, and to the rotary disk, a control driving force of a reverse driving unit **600** is transmitted. That is, a driving force of a rotary shaft of a reverse motor **602** of the reverse driving unit **600** is transmitted to the rotation control gear **512** via a reverse clutch **604** and a control drive gear **606**.

(41) The above-described sliding body **520** is provided with a plurality of arms **522** in a swingable manner, and on tip ends of these arms **522**, rollers **524** are provided. The other sliding body **530** is provided with a plurality of arms **532** in a swingable manner, and on tip ends of these arms **532**, rollers **534** are provided. On the other hand, on the front and rear surfaces of the rotary disk **510**, recessed portions **514** and **516** are respectively provided so that the rollers **524** and **534** described above slide in radial directions.

(42) In the recessed portion **514** on the input side of the rotary disk **510**, according to sliding of the sliding body **520** along the driven shaft **154**, the arms **522** open and close in radial directions around pivots **522C**. The arms **522** are closed in the “ON” state illustrated in FIG. 7(A), and are open in the “OFF” state illustrated in FIG. 7(B). On the other hand, in the recessed portion **516** on the output side of the rotary disk **510**, according to sliding of the sliding body **530** along the driven shaft **154**, the arms **532** open and close in radial directions around pivots **532C**. The arms **532** are closed in the “ON” state illustrated in FIG. 7(A), and are open in the “OFF” state illustrated in FIG. 7(C).

(43) The sliding bodies **520** and **530** are slid along splines in the direction of the driven shaft **154** by the levers **526** and **536**, and the levers **526** and **536** are connected by wires, etc., to the accelerator lever **610** interlocking with movement of the accelerator pedal. As illustrated in FIG.

7(A), in the ON state where the accelerator pedal is stepped on, both of the arms 522 and 532 are closed as illustrated in FIG. 7(A), and in the OFF state where the accelerator pedal is not stepped on, both of the arms 522 and 532 open as illustrated in FIG. 7(C).

(44) Next, in the present example, as illustrated in FIG. 4, in addition to the reverse motor 602 and the reverse clutch 604 of the reverse driving unit 600 described above, an airbag sensor 700, etc., are connected to the ECU 320. The airbag sensor 700 is a sensor that detects whether an airbag has operated. A gyro sensor 702 is a sensor that detects rotation or orientation with respect to each of the front-rear, left-right, and up-down directions, and detects an acceleration. An inter-vehicular distance radar 704 is a sensor that detects a distance to a vehicle running ahead. An ABS (Antilock Brake System) actuator 706 is for actuating the ABS.

(45) FIG. 3(C) illustrates the entirety of a power transmission system including the above-described impact reducing mechanism 500, configured so that the idle running mechanism 100 and the impact reducing mechanism 500 are provided between the engine 130 and the transmission mechanism 202, and the reverse driving unit 600 is provided in the impact reducing mechanism 500.

(46) Next, operation of the present example will be described with reference to the flowchart of FIG. 9 as well. First, at the time of acceleration and running (Ta to Tc) illustrated in FIGS. 6(A) and 6(B), as illustrated in FIG. 7(A), the idle running mechanism 100 goes into an ON state (Yes in Step S30), and the sliding bodies 520 and 530 are separated from the rotary disk 510. Accordingly, both of the arms 522 and 532 are closed. Therefore, the impact reducing mechanism 500 goes into an OFF state where it does not operate (Step S32).

(47) On the other hand, at the time of deceleration (Tc to Td) illustrated in FIGS. 6(A) and 6(B), as illustrated in FIG. 7(C), the idle running mechanism 100 goes into an OFF state (No in Step S30), the accelerator pedal is released, and the accelerator lever 610 turns. Therefore, the sliding bodies 520 and 530 gradually approach the rotary disk 510, and both of the arms 522 and 532 gradually open. Then, at the outer side of the rotary disk 510, the arms 522 and 532 are pulled, and as compared with the case in FIG. 7(A), the torque increases and acts in a direction in which the rotation speed decreases, and becomes an ON state (Step S34). Therefore, an impact when the idle running mechanism 100 is turned OFF is reduced, and smooth shifting to an idle running state is enabled.

(48) In other words, it can be considered that a diameter of a gear that drives the rotary disk 510 differs between in FIG. 7(A) and in FIG. 7(C). In the case of FIG. 7(A), the gear has a small diameter, and in the case of FIG. 7(C), the gear has a large diameter. As the gear increases in diameter, the rotation speed of the rotary disk 510 decreases.

(49) At the time of the operation described above, when the airbag sensor 700 detects an airbag operation (Yes in Step S36), when the gyro sensor 702 detects a certain amount or more of change in posture or acceleration (Yes in Step S38), when the inter-vehicular distance radar 704 detects that the distance to a vehicle ahead has become a certain distance or less (Yes in Step S40), and when the ABS actuator 706 detects an ABS operation (Yes in Step S42), the reverse driving unit 600 is turned ON by the impact reducing program 722 (refer to FIG. 4) (Step S44). That is, the reverse clutch 604 is turned ON, and the reverse motor 602 is driven. Therefore, the rotary disk 510 is forcibly stopped, and the driven shaft 154 also stops rotating, and the automobile stops.

(50) In this way, according to the present example, the impact reducing mechanism 500 is added to the idle running mechanism 100, so that the following effects are obtained: a. The impact reducing mechanism reduces an impact at the time of ON/OFF switching of the idle running mechanism 100. b. In an emergency, the impact reducing mechanism can stop the automobile and functions as an automatic brake.

Example 3

(51) Next, with reference to FIGS. 10 to 14, an example of the collision mitigation mechanism of the present invention will be described. The present example has the purpose of mitigating an

impact at the time of a collision of an automobile. In FIG. 10, the drive shaft 12 of the engine (or motor) 130 as a drive source is connected to the collision mitigation mechanism 800 of the present example via an appropriate clutch device 20. The collision mitigation mechanism 800 includes a high-load ball clutch 810 and a reversing high-load multiple disk clutch 850.

(52) Among these members, as the clutch device 20, various publicly known clutch devices may be applied, or the idle running mechanism 100 of Example 1 described above may be used. The high-load ball clutch 810 consists of a driving force transmission ring 820 and a sliding body 830. The driving force transmission ring 820 is joined to the drive shaft 12, and consists of an input-side transmission ring 822 and an output-side transmission ring 824. The input-side transmission ring 822 of these transmission rings rotates together with the drive shaft 12. On the other hand, the output-side transmission ring 824 is freely rotatable forward and reversely, and rotates forward and reversely according to a position of the sliding body 830. The input-side transmission ring 822 is provided with a plurality of ball rails 822A along a rotary shaft direction. The output-side transmission ring 824 is provided with a plurality of ball rails 824A that gradually open in a direction orthogonal to the rotary shaft. Both of the ball rails 822A and 824A are provided at even intervals in a circumferential direction of the rotary shaft.

(53) On the other hand, the sliding body 830 includes an input-side (engine-side) annular ball holding portion 832 and an output-side annular ball holding portion 834. Inside the input-side annular ball holding portion 832, a plurality of balls 832A are provided corresponding to the ball rails 822A, and are biased to the rail sides by springs 832B. On the other hand, inside the opposite output-side annular ball holding portion 834, a plurality of balls 834A are provided corresponding to the ball rails 824A, and are biased to the rail sides by springs 834B. Between these annular ball holding portions 832 and 834, a collision mitigation lever 836 is provided, and is driven by a ball clutch actuator 838.

(54) The balls 832A of the input-side annular ball holding portion 832 of the sliding body 830 are in contact with the ball rails 822A. The balls 834A of the output-side annular ball holding portion 834 come into contact with the ball rails 824A according to a position of the sliding body 830. When the sliding body is at the position illustrated in FIG. 10, the balls 834A are in contact with the ball rails 824A, however, the balls are not in contact in FIGS. 12 and 13 described later.

(55) Next, the input-side transmission ring 822 of the driving force transmission ring 820 described above is provided with an inertia absorbing gear mechanism 840. The inertia absorbing gear mechanism 840 consists of a gear 842 provided on an outer circumference of the input-side transmission ring 822 of the driving force transmission ring 820, a gear 844 that meshes with the gear 842, a gear 846 provided on a rotary shaft 844A of the gear 844, and a gear 848 that meshes with the gear 846, and is connected to the reversing high-load multiple disk clutch 850. The inertia absorbing gear mechanism 840 operates when the drive shaft 12 rotates, and a driving force is transmitted to the gear 842.fwdarw.the gear 844.fwdarw.the gear 846.fwdarw.the gear 848.fwdarw.the reversing high-load multiple disk clutch 850 in order.

(56) Gear ratios of the respective gears are set so that, when a collision is detected and the reversing high-load multiple disk clutch 850 is turned ON as described later although the reversing high-load multiple disk clutch 850 is normally OFF, a regenerative/backing up motor 864 rotates at a high rotation speed via the reversing high-load multiple disk clutch 850, in other words, a greater regenerative load is applied and inertia is absorbed.

(57) The reversing high-load multiple disk clutch 850 is a multiple disk type so as to withstand a high load, and is switched between ON/OFF (turned ON/OFF) by a reverse lever 852. The reverse lever 852 is driven by a multiple disk clutch actuator 854. FIG. 10 illustrates a state where the reversing high-load multiple disk clutch 850 is OFF.

(58) On the other hand, the output-side transmission ring 824 of the driving force transmission ring 820 is provided with a driving force output shaft 14. This output shaft 14 is connected to a tire side of the automobile so as to transmit the driving force. The output-side transmission ring 824 is

freely rotatable forward and reversely as described above, and therefore, the output shaft **14** also rotates forward and reversely. The output shaft **14** is provided with a reversing mechanism **860**. The reversing mechanism **860** consists of a gear **862** provided on the output shaft **14**, a regenerative/backing up motor **864** and a gear **861** that drive the gear in a reverse direction, and a gear **866** that transmits an output of the reversing high-load multiple disk clutch **850**. Reverse rotation of the regenerative/backing up motor **864** is transmitted to the output shaft **14** so as to become a large torque by the gears **861** and **862** although its rotation speed is low.

(59) Here, operation of the high-load ball clutch **810** configured as described above will be described. The sliding body **830** is normally at the position illustrated in FIG. **10**. That is, a driving force of the drive shaft **12** is transmitted to the input-side transmission ring **822**. The ball rails **822A** of the driving force transmission ring **820** and the input-side annular ball holding portion **832** of the output-side annular ball holding portion **834** engage the balls **832A** of the driving force transmission ring **820** and the ball rails **824A** of the output-side transmission ring **824** of the sliding body **830** in order. That is, the high-load ball clutch **810** is in an ON state. On the other hand, when the ball clutch actuator **838** is driven, by the collision mitigation lever **836**, the sliding body **830** is slid as illustrated in FIG. **12** or **13**. Then, the balls **834A** of the output-side annular ball holding portion **834** separate from the ball rails **824A** of the output-side transmission ring **824**. Therefore, the high-load ball clutch **810** goes into an OFF state.

(60) FIG. **11** illustrates a collision mitigation control device **870** of the present example, and to an ECU **872**, a collision detection sensor **874** is connected in addition to the above-described clutch device **20**, vehicle speed sensor **304**, ball clutch actuator **838**, multiple disk clutch actuator **854**, and regenerative/backing up motor **864**. In the ECU **872**, a collision mitigation program **876** is prepared. When this program is executed in the ECU **872**, the operation illustrated in FIG. **11(B)** is performed.

(61) Next, operation of the present example will be described with reference to FIGS. **12** and **13** as well. In normal running, as illustrated in FIG. **10**, the clutch device **20** is ON, the high-load ball clutch **810** is ON, and the reversing high-load multiple disk clutch **859** is OFF. Therefore, the driving force of the engine **130** is transmitted to the drive shaft **12** and the clutch device **20**, the high-load ball clutch **810**, and the output shaft **14** in order. In this running state, when a collision accident occurs and is detected by the collision detection sensor **874** (Yes in Step **S800** in FIG. **11(B)**), the ECU **872** executing the collision mitigation program **876** turns the clutch device **20** OFF (Step **S802**) and drives the high-load ball clutch actuator **838** and the high-load multiple disk clutch actuator **854** (Step **S804**). Accordingly, even when a driver continuously steps on the accelerator pedal, the clutch device **20** is turned OFF, so that the driving force of the engine **130** is not transmitted. In addition, as illustrated in FIG. **12**, the high-load ball clutch **810** switches from ON to OFF, and the reversing high-load multiple disk clutch **850** switches from OFF to ON.

(62) Then, as illustrated in FIG. **12**, the driving force of the drive shaft **12** is transmitted to the reversing high-load multiple disk clutch **850** via the inertia absorbing gear mechanism **840**. Then, the driving force is transmitted to the gear **862** via the gear **866**, and inertia is absorbed and the driving force acts to rotate the output shaft **14** at a low speed (Step **S806**). On the other hand, when the gear **862** rotates, the regenerative/backing up motor **864** also rotates, and so-called regenerative driving is also performed. Due to these operations, the output shaft **14** rapidly decreases in rotation speed, and goes from a forward rotating state into a rotation stopping state. That is, the drive shaft **12** is rapidly stopped due to actions of the inertia absorbing gear mechanism **840**, the reversing high-load multiple disk clutch **850**, and the reversing mechanism **860** acting in this order. Then, when the vehicle speed sensor **304** detects that the vehicle speed has become equal to "0" (Yes in Step **S808**), as illustrated in FIG. **13**, the ECU **872** drives the regenerative/backing up motor **864** (Step **S810**) and drives reversely the output shaft **14** for several seconds (Step **S812**), and then stops driving of the regenerative/backing up motor **864**. For example, when the vehicle

speed at the time of the collision is 50 km/h, the output shaft reverses for 5 seconds, and when the vehicle speed at the time of the collision is 40 km/h, the output shaft reverses for 4 seconds. At this time, as described above, setting is made so that reverse rotation of the regenerative/backing up motor **864** becomes a large torque by the gears **861** and **862** while its rotation speed is low, so that the output shaft **14** rotates reversely with a large torque. Accordingly, the automobile stops after backing up for several seconds (Step **S814**). Along with reverse driving of the regenerative/backing up motor **864**, the reversing high-load multiple disk clutch **850** goes OFF.

(63) FIG. **14** illustrates changes in vehicle speed when the collision mitigation mechanism **800** of the present example operates. Graphs GA to GE represent states of running at respective speeds of 10, 20, 30, 40, and 50 km/h, and on the assumption that a collision is detected at the time TA, rapid deceleration is performed and the vehicle speed reaches "0" at the time TB. Thereafter, the speed becomes negative and the automobile backs up, and the speed reaches "0" again at the time TC and the automobile stops. In the illustrated example, the automobile backs up for 1 second in the case of the speed of 10 km/h, backs up for 2 seconds in the case of the speed of 20 km/h, backs up for 3 seconds in the case of the speed of 30 km/h, backs up for 4 seconds in the case of the speed of 40 km/h, and backs up for 5 seconds in the case of the speed of 50 km/h.

(64) As described above, according to the present example, a. When a collision is detected, the automobile is rapidly decelerated and stopped. b. After the stopping, the automobile is backed up. c. After backing up for several seconds, the automobile is stopped again.

Accordingly, the automobile is suddenly braked from the time point of the collision, and further slightly backed up and then stopped, and therefore, further expansion of the collision accident is reduced, and damage from the collision is mitigated.

Example 4

(65) Next, Example 4 of the present invention will be described with reference to FIGS. **15** to **20**. As illustrated in FIG. **15**, in the present example, the above-described idle running mechanism **100**, impact reducing mechanism **501**, and collision mitigation mechanism **800** are provided. In the impact reducing mechanism **501**, as compared with the example described above, a recessed portion **517** of the rotary disk **510** rotates independently of the rotation control gear **512**, and a joining gear unit **650** is provided instead of the reverse driving unit **600**. A primary-side gear **652** of the joining gear unit **650** is in mesh with the rotation control gear **512**, and a secondary-side gear **654** is in mesh with a drive gear **656** provided on the sliding body **530**. In addition, gear ratios of the gears **652** and **654** are set so that the drive gear **656** rotates at an increased speed as compared with the rotation control gear **512**.

(66) Next, the entire operation of the present example will be described. FIG. **20** illustrates the entire operation. In FIGS. to **19** illustrating operation states, the thick line represents a driving force transmission path. (1) At the time of low speed, low-speed rotation with large torque: In this case, as illustrated in FIG. **15**, the idle running mechanism **100** is ON, the impact reducing mechanism **501** is ON, and the collision mitigation mechanism **800** is in a running state. That is, running is performed in a state where an impact at the time of turning ON of the idle running mechanism **100** is reduced. (2) At the time of medium speed, medium-speed rotation: As illustrated in FIG. **16**, the idle running mechanism **100** is ON, and in the impact reducing mechanism **501**, the sliding body **530** slides due to action of the joining gear unit **650**, the input side is ON and the output side is OFF, and the collision mitigation mechanism **800** is in a running state. That is, the state falls between FIG. 7(A) and FIG. 7(B), and acceleration is performed while the impact is mitigated. (3) At the time of high speed, high-speed rotation: As illustrated in FIG. **17**, the idle running mechanism **100** is ON, the impact reducing mechanism **501** is OFF, and the collision mitigation mechanism **800** is in a running state. (4) At the time of inertia and regenerative power generation: As illustrated in FIG. **18**, the idle running mechanism **100** is OFF, the impact reducing mechanism **501** is ON, and the collision mitigation mechanism **800** is in a regenerative operation state. That is, an impact of turning OFF of the idle running mechanism **100** is mitigated by the impact reducing

mechanism **501**. On the other hand, rotation of the driven shaft **154** is transmitted to the regenerative/backing up motor **864** and regeneration/power generation are performed, and the rotation speed of the output shaft **14** decreases and it stops with time. (5) At the time of reverse rotation for impact mitigation: As illustrated in FIG. **19**, the idle running mechanism **100** is OFF, the impact reducing mechanism **501** is ON, and the collision mitigation mechanism **800** is in a reversing state. That is, the regenerative/backing up motor **864** starts to rotate, and the output shaft **14** rotates reversely. Since the impact reducing mechanism **501** is ON, an impact of the reverse rotation start is reduced. Then, after backing up by reversing for a certain period of time, the automobile stops.

(67) In this way, according to the present example, the idle running mechanism **100**, the impact reducing mechanism **501**, and the collision mitigation mechanism **800** are connected, so that an impact at the time of collision mitigation can also be reduced.

(68) The present invention is not limited to the examples described above, and can be variously modified without departing from the spirit of the present invention. For example, the present invention includes the following as well. (1) As the magnets **112** of the outer rotors **110** and the magnets **152** of the inner rotor **150** shown in the examples described above, rare-earth magnets such as Nd—Fe—B (neodymium-iron-boron) magnets are preferable examples, however, various magnets may be used. (2) Although the plurality of outer rotors **110** are provided around the inner rotor **150** in the examples described above, it is also possible that a cylindrical outer rotor **110** is formed, and inside the outer rotor, magnets are disposed. It can be arbitrarily determined which of the outer rotor **110** and the inner rotor **150** is connected to the engine **130** side. (3) As the idle running control actuator **166** shown in the examples described above and other actuators, various publicly known techniques such as electric and hydraulic actuators may be used. (4) The relationships between various switches and ON/OFF shown in the examples described above may be inversed. For example, in the example described above, the accelerator switch **302** goes ON when the accelerator pedal is stepped on, however, conversely, even in the case where the accelerator switch **302** is turned OFF when the accelerator pedal is stepped on, it is possible to detect whether the accelerator pedal is being stepped on. The same applies to other switches. (5) In the examples described above, the idle running control program **322**, etc., are provided in the ECU **320** that controls the entire operation of the automobile, however, a control device may be provided separately. (6) The flowchart illustrated in FIG. **5** is also an example, and various steps may be applied as long as it is possible to detect a situation where safe idle running is possible. For example, when a slope of a road is slight or the road is slightly curved, idle running is considered to pose no problem. (7) The idle running mechanism, etc., of the present invention may be installed inside the clutch mechanism **200** or the transmission mechanism **202** that the automobile originally includes. (8) In Example 3 or 4 described above, when the sliding direction (rightward in FIG. **10**) of the sliding body **830** of the high-load ball clutch **810** matches an automobile running direction, this provides an advantage that the sliding body **830** easily slides and the high-load ball clutch **810** easily goes OFF at the time of a collision. (9) In the examples described above, a collision is detected by the collision detection sensor **874**, however, a collision may be detected by a front camera or an infrared sensor. (10) It is also possible that a tilt and spin caused by an overturn of the vehicle at the time of a collision are detected by a gyro sensor, and an ABS (Antilock Brake System) brake is actuated. (11) The present invention is preferably applied to an automobile by way of example, and is also applicable to various mobile objects such as trains, boats and ships.

INDUSTRIAL APPLICABILITY

(69) According to the present invention, when a collision is detected, a rapid deceleration of a vehicle is performed, and backing up after stopping is performed and then stopping is performed. Therefore, further expansion of the collision accident is reduced, and the collision is mitigated. In addition, idle running is performed upon detection of a state where safe idle running is possible by the idle running mechanism, so that while the configuration is simple, effective use of energy, an

improvement in fuel efficiency, and reduction in environmental load can be realized, and this is preferable for automobiles, etc.

(70) The disclosure of Japanese Patent Application No. 2020-149490 filed on Sep. 4, 2020 is incorporated herein.

REFERENCE SIGNS LIST

(71) **12**: Drive shaft **14**: Output shaft **20**: Clutch device **100**: Idle running mechanism **110**: Outer rotor **112**, **152**: Magnet **114**: Rotary shaft **120**: Gear mechanism **130**: Engine **132**: Drive shaft **134**: Main gear **136**: Driven gear **150**: Inner rotor **154**: Driven shaft **155**: Output shaft **156**: Frictional material **160**: Sliding mechanism **162**: Lever **164**: Spring **166**: Idle running control actuator **200**: Clutch mechanism **202**: Transmission mechanism **204**: Axle **230**: Motor **300**: Idle running control device **302**: Accelerator switch **304**: Vehicle speed sensor **306**: Brake switch **308**: Handle steering angle sensor **310**: Shift position switch **312**: Front obstacle detection sensor **314**: Road surface angle sensor **320**: ECU **322**: Idle running control program **500**, **501**: Impact reducing mechanism **510**: Rotary disk **512**: Rotation control gear **514**, **516**, **517**: Recessed portion **520**, **530**: Sliding body **522**, **532**: Arm **522C**, **532C**: Pivot **524**, **534**: Roller **526**, **536**: Lever **600**: Reverse driving unit **602**: Reverse motor **604**: Reverse clutch **606**: Control drive gear **610**: Accelerator lever **650**: Joining gear unit **652**, **654**: Gear **656**: Drive gear **700**: Airbag sensor **702**: Gyro sensor **704**: Inter-vehicular distance radar **706**: ABS actuator **722**: Impact reducing program **800**: Collision mitigation mechanism **810**: High-load ball clutch **820**: Driving force transmission ring **822**: Input-side transmission ring **822A**, **824A**: Ball rail **824**: Output-side transmission ring **830**: Sliding body **832**, **834**: Annular ball holding portion **832A**, **834A**: Ball **832B**, **834B**: Spring **836**: Collision mitigation lever **838**: Ball clutch actuator **840**: Inertia absorbing gear mechanism **842**, **844**: Gear **844A**: Rotary shaft **846**, **848**: Gear **850**: Reversing high-load multiple disk clutch **852**: Reverse lever **854**: Multiple disk clutch actuator **860**: Reversing mechanism **861**, **862**: Gear **864**: Regenerative/backing up motor **866**: Gear **870**: Collision mitigation control device **872**: ECU **874**: Collision detection sensor **876**: Collision mitigation program

Claims

1. A collision mitigation mechanism for mitigating damage from a vehicle collision, comprising: a collision detection means configured to detect a collision of a vehicle; a clutch means configured to block transmission of a driving force of a drive source in response to a collision detected by the collision detection means; a deceleration and stop means configured to decelerate and stop the vehicle in a state where the clutch means blocks transmission of the driving force of the drive source in response to a detection of the collision of the vehicle detected by the collision detection means; a backing up means configured to back up and stop the vehicle after the vehicle is stopped by the deceleration and stop means in a state where the clutch means blocks transmission of the driving force of the drive source; and a collision mitigation control means configured to, in response to the collision detected by the collision detection means, (1) decelerate and stop the vehicle travelling in a forward direction by the deceleration and stop means, and then, in response to a detection that the speed of the vehicle has become equal to zero, (2) back up the vehicle to travel for a several seconds in a reverse direction from a point of the collision and then stop the vehicle at a point reversely distanced from the point of the collision by the backing up means.
2. The collision mitigation mechanism according to claim 1, wherein the deceleration and stop means is a regeneration means configured to absorb inertia of the vehicle.
3. The collision mitigation mechanism according to claim 2, wherein the backing up means includes a motor means, and the regeneration means is configured by rotating reversely the motor means.
4. A clutch device to be used as the clutch means of the collision mitigation mechanism according to claim 1, comprising; an idle running mechanism configured to turn ON and OFF transmission of

power of an input side to an output side; and an idle running control device configured to control the turning ON/OFF, wherein the idle running mechanism comprises: an output side rotor mechanism and an input side rotor mechanism located at inner side of the output side rotor mechanism; a plurality of first magnets on a periphery of the output side rotor mechanism and a plurality of second magnets on outer periphery of the input side rotor mechanism, the plurality of first and second magnets being aligned to have alternate polarities N and S between the respective pair of the plurality of first and second magnets; and a sliding means configured to transmit rotation of the input-side rotor to the output-side rotor by a magnetic force generated between the magnets of the input-side rotor and the magnets of the output-side rotor in response to the turning ON of the idle running mechanism, and slide at least one of the rotors so that no magnetic force is generated between the magnets of the input-side rotor and the magnets of the output-side rotor in response to the turning OFF of the idle running mechanism, and the idle running control device comprising: a sensor means configured to detect a running state of the vehicle and road conditions; and wherein the idle running control means is configured to generate a corresponding idle running control signal to turn OFF the idle running mechanism in response to the deceleration of the vehicle while the vehicle is traveling straight on a flat road, based on detection results by the sensor means, and output the corresponding idle running control signal to the sliding means.

5. The clutch device according to claim 4, wherein the input side rotor mechanism is provided on an outer circumference of the output-side rotor mechanism, and a power transmission mechanism that transmits power of an input shaft into which power is input to the input side rotor mechanism, is provided.

6. The clutch device according to claim 4, wherein the sensor means comprises at least one of: an accelerator switch configured to detect whether an accelerator pedal has been stepped on; a vehicle speed sensor configured to detect a vehicle speed; a brake switch configured to detect whether a brake pedal has been stepped on; a handle steering angle sensor configured to detect whether a handle has been turned; a shift position switch configured to detect a position of a shift lever; a front obstacle detection sensor configured to detect whether an obstacle is present ahead; and a road surface angle sensor configured to detect a slope of a road surface.

7. The clutch device according to claim 4, further comprising: a rotary disk attached to a driven shaft to be driven to rotate by the output-side rotor, the rotary disk including a front surface and a rear surface with respect to an axial direction of the driven shaft; an output shaft engaging with the driven shaft; a first sliding body on the front surface of the rotary disk and configured to slide in the axial direction of the driven shaft; a second sliding body on the rear surface of the rotary disk and configured to slide in an axial direction of the output shaft; a plurality of first arms extending from the first sliding body towards the front surface of the rotary disk and a plurality of second arms extending from the second sliding body towards the rear surface of the rotary disk, the plurality of first arms and second arms being swingable in a radial direction of the rotary disk; and an impact reducing mechanism configured to move the plurality of first and second arms to an outer circumferential side of the rotary disk so that the plurality of first and second arms being pulled at outer periphery side of the rotary disk, in response to a switch of the idle running mechanism from ON to OFF.

8. The clutch device according to claim 7, further comprising a reverse driving means configured to stop rotation of the rotary disk in an emergency.

9. The clutch device according to claim 4, wherein the output side rotor mechanism includes a plurality of output side rotors arranged around an outer periphery of the input side rotor mechanism, each of the plurality of output side rotors being configured to rotate around an axis of the respective one of the plurality of output side rotors, and the plurality of the first magnets are on an outer periphery of each of the plurality of input side rotors.

10. The clutch device according to claim 4, wherein the output side rotor mechanism includes a cylindrical rotor, and the plurality of the first magnets are on an inner periphery of the cylindrical

rotor.

11. The collision mitigation mechanism according to claim 1, wherein the collision mitigation control means is further configured to, in response to the collision detected by the collision detection means, decelerate and stop the vehicle by the deceleration and stop means, and then, in response to a detection that the speed of the vehicle has become equal to zero, back up the vehicle by a time depending on a vehicle speed at the time of the collision, and thereafter stop the vehicle.
